

WBF 2019 ANNUAL REPORT

Address: Rruga "Skënderbeg"
No. 8, Kati IV, Ap. 35/36.
Tirana, Albania

info@westernbalkansfund.org
Phone: +355 42 400420

WBF 2019
ANNUAL REPORT



TABLE OF CONTENTS

06

Message from Executive Director

07

About Western Balkans Fund

07

Our Vision, Mission & Strategy

08

Key Activities of WBF Governing
Bodies

10

WBF 2ND CALL FOR
REGIONAL PROJECT
PROPOSALS IN FIGURES

16

WBF GRANT IN ACTION -
CULTURE

33

EDUCATION &
SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH

45

SUSTAINABLE
DEVELOPMENT

56

Beyond Grants

57

Monitoring

59

Visibility Actions

60

Networking in & Beyond the
Region

61

WBF 3rd Call for Proposals for
Regional Projects

61

Western Balkans Fund Internship
Program

EMPOWERING
CHAMPIONS OF
REGIONAL COOPERATION
IN WESTERN BALKANS

WB ANNUAL REPORT

Western Balkans Fund presents its yearly progress on Call implementation period basis. The content of this report includes five chapters: grant making, strategic perspective, promotion, partnership and networking in regional and international level from 1 January 2019 to 30 December 2019.



Findings and Interpretations

Information and data collected presented in this report were conducted by the staff of the Western Balkans Fund with external contributions. The findings, interpretations and conclusions expressed in the chapter presenting projects supported by WBF, do not necessarily reflect the views of Western Balkans Fund, its Council of Senior Officials, or the governments they represent. The WBF does not guarantee the accuracy of the data included in this chapter, more specifically, information related to the grantees reports and data.

Rights and Permissions

The information presented in this report are subject to copyright. WBF encourages dissemination of its knowledge; this work may be reproduced, in whole or in part, for non-commercial purposes as long as full attribution to this work is given. Any queries on rights and licenses, including subsidiary rights, should be addressed to Western Balkans Fund Secretariat.

This Report was prepared with the financial support of International Visegrad Fund



MESSAGE FROM EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR



DR. GJERGJ MURRA

Dear Partners, Colleagues and Friends of Western Balkans Fund,

Pleased to present to you this Second Edition of the Western Balkans Fund Annual Report, a joint product of the Secretariat, aiming to make visible and to inform about Fund's main achievements during 2019.

The WBF today is a reality, a growing, sustainable and visible organization, implementing its core objectives: supporting innovative and meaningful regional projects implemented by civil society organizations and other relevant grass-roots institutions.

Since its establishment, WBF's Secretariat has managed to successfully launch three regional Calls for proposals that have attracted a lot of interest. We have selected and supported 68 grantees in the spheres of sustainable development, cultural cooperation and education.

Most important: It has helped the creation of networks of cooperation between 3500 Civil Society Organizations, education and research institutions, cultural and sports associations, business and local elected bodies, etc.

In this report you can find a detailed and in-depth information about the 25 projects we have supported in 2019, but also more about our different activities, beyond grant making.

The Fund is proud of its short past, but it is resolutely turned toward the future. We look forward to accomplish these objectives and continue serving to the champions of regional cooperation around Western Balkans region. That's why in 2019, lots of time and efforts were dedicated to the WBF Strategic and Organizational development process. Our 2020-2025 Strategy, charts an ambitious way forward: the regional context and increased demand for cooperation requires nothing but organizational excellence and agility from the WBF.

As they say, dear friends, "success is best when it is shared". And this is the main scope of this presentation: to share with you our achievements and plans for the future, remaining hopeful to continue cooperation with all of you in our journey, to support the region's peaceful and European future.

On behalf of WBF Team, I wish to thank all our collaborators, supporters, partners, grantees and our friends!

Heartfelt gratitude for your constructive and treasurable partnership!

Dr. Gjergj Murra



ABOUT WESTERN BALKANS FUND

Western Balkans Fund is an international organization located in Tirana, Albania, founded by the governments of Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo*, Montenegro, North Macedonia and Serbia. Its establishment, as an all-inclusive and regionally owned initiative, is considered as a clear sign of a new cooperation spirit taking roots in the Balkans.

Western Balkans Fund is a uniquely mechanism that serves as a platform for strengthening and promotion of regional cooperation around Western Balkans. Due to its institutional nature and being governed and funded by its contracting parties, WBF embodies the values of regional ownership, acting as a bridge between governments, civil society and citizens in our region. Its mission is a materialization of commitments of governments in the region to peaceful cooperation and good neighbourly relations.

WBF is exceptionally placed to engage with, and to support regional stakeholders across social, educational, cultural, scientific and economic sectors, thus advancing regional cooperation in various areas of social activity. WBF is committed to increasing its own internal capacity to perform its unique role at the highest level, also by being a flexible, needs-driven and responsive mechanism, bringing both tactical and strategic support to partners, advancing the intensity and quality of regional cooperation.

In its third year of existence, WBF is projected to directly and strategically contribute to increased opportunities for stakeholders, to advance the intensity and quality of regional cooperation in the Western Balkans over the longer term, while also providing the EU with a regionally-owned, effective and reliable mechanism for facilitating needs-driven and tailored support to regional cooperation.

Thus far, WBF has been able to accomplish its mission on two distinct levels:

- (a) strengthen its presence and better understand the needs of stakeholders engaging in and promoting regional cooperation and
- (b) its grant-making to date.

Our Vision



*The Western Balkans Fund envisions a region at peace with itself; prosperously integrated into its European home. It envisages a region where exchange and fruitful, mutually beneficial relations of cooperation between people at all levels and from all walks of life are the norm rather than the exception.



Our Mission

Fund's mission is to promote:

- The development of closer cooperation and strengthening of ties between the Western Balkans Contracting Parties;
- The integration of the Contracting Parties into the European Union;
- Common presentation of the WBF Contracting Parties to the third countries.



Our Strategy

During 2019, WBF has devoted part of its capacities and resources in developing its Strategic Plan for the mid-term period (2020 - 2025).

WBF's Strategic Plan represents the basis of cooperation between the Organization and Civil Society actors around the region, based on principles of: a) strengthening regional cooperation, b) highlighting the role of people to people links in these processes c) transparency in grant making and d) increasing the role/participation of Civil Society in regional reconciliation processes.



Key Activities of WBF Governing Bodies

WBF Third Conference of Ministers of Foreign Affairs, 2019 was organized by Pristina WBF Chairmanship-in-Office, as a side event of Berlin Process Foreign Ministers' Meeting, in Warsaw, Poland. The most important political event of the Fund underlined with appreciation the positive results achieved by WBF, in accomplishing its core objectives: enhancing regional cooperation and good neighbourly relations, by supporting human mobility, "soft connectivity" and strengthening people-to-people contacts in our region.

The Ministers, considered very positively the high number of organizations involved in the WBF activities, as a clear sign of the readiness, maturity and willingness of our region to further cooperate and noted with satisfaction that Western Balkans Fund, through the Call for Proposals, is creating broad and vivid networks covering every angle of the region



Council of Senior Officials - The WBF Council of Senior Officials met 3 times in Tirana, during 2019, under the Chairmanship of Pristina. In these meetings was discussed and taken stock of the achievements of the Initiative during the period January– December 2019. The Council took the necessary decisions, paving the way to further activities of the Secretariat in the upcoming period. These CSO meetings were another positive message of the good cooperation spirit between WB Contracting Parties and of their willingness to continue supporting WBF



During the last meeting in December, a special session was dedicated to the WBF Strategic Development aiming to finalize the document for better shaping Fund's mid-term, actions and structure in the future.





WBF 2ND CALL FOR REGIONAL PROJECT PROPOSALS

The Second Call for Proposals was launched on 2 November 2018 and the deadline for submission of Project Proposals was 13 December 2018. The overall objective of the Call was to contribute to regional cooperation, and strengthen regional cohesion in the WB6 region.

The Call had foreseen three main areas of intervention:

1. Cultural cooperation
2. Education and scientific exchanges
3. Sustainable development

Promoting cross-border cooperation, European integration, gender equality and matters pertaining to youth were the crosscutting issues, covering actions under all areas of activities.

- The overall indicative amount made available under this Call, was EUR 260,000.
- Max grant requested, not exceeded EUR 12,000.
- The applicant should have provided at least 20% of the total costs of the project.
- The planned duration of a project may not exceed 12 months.
- It was foreseen to have 24 projects awarded, 6 more compared with First Call.

The project partnerships represented the central requirement of the Call:

- Project partnership is consisted of the lead-applicant and minimum two project partners.
- Partnership parties must come from at least three different WB6 Contracting Parties

The institutions eligible to apply under the 2nd Call for Proposals were the following: Civil society organizations (NGOs), Local or regional public entities including municipalities or regional development agencies, etc. Business associations including: business clusters, agriculture associations, chamber of commerce, tourism associations, etc. Educational institutions including universities, schools, institutes, libraries, research centers, academies of science/music/art, etc. Institutions of culture or sports including museums, art galleries, theatres, or associations of cultural institutions, sport association, etc.

Dissemination

The Call was actively disseminated through online and social media channels:

Web Page <http://westernbalkansfund.org/web/>

Facebook <https://www.facebook.com/WesternBalkansFund/>

Twitter https://twitter.com/balkans_fund

Instagram <https://www.instagram.com/westernbalkansfund/>

LinkedIn <https://www.linkedin.com/company/westernbalkansfund/>

For its dissemination WBF Secretariat organized six Information Sessions, that resulted in great interest and high expectations from the civil society organizations (CSO), universities, schools, associations of arts, culture and sports, local authorities, chambers of commerce and industry, media organizations and also other non-profit stakeholders.

More than 500 participants in the sessions were informed in details about the Call and more than 70 direct questions and recommendations were recorded.

FAQ section link <http://westernbalkansfund.org/frequently-asked-questions-faq/>

Just from the Facebook posts, announcing the Call, WBF managed to reach 62.000 people. During the Call, the total traffic of the WBF web page reached up to 1200 visitors.



Belgrade- 15 November 2018



Prishtina- 19 November 2018



Skopje- 16 November 2018



Sarajevo- 14 November 2018



Podgorica- 12 November 2018



Tirana - 8 November 2018

Western Balkans Fund – Partnership Platform

The dissemination of the Call, once again confirmed WBF Online Partnership Platform, as an useful virtual tool, a meeting point for organizations wishing to engage in cross-border and regional projects and looking for suitable partners. According to WBF's observation, this platform was utilized by both small and new organizations, or those newly engaging in cross-border and regional projects, as well as those who already have a significant track record of regional collaboration(s). Through this action, WBF aims to further develop it in order to calibrate it to the needs of applicants and grantees, and we anticipate that, if such advancements to the platform are made, civil society organizations will be able to use it for partnership searches for and beyond WBF's grant calls, thus making additional contributions to increasing civil society organizations' regional collaboration potential. Until now, WBF's Online Partnership Platform has more than 1200 active members.



EVALUATION PROCESS

Within a period of 2 months WBF staff managed to effectively assess 224 applications, that resulted eligible. Through the professional assessment by 3 evaluation units, all projects were classified and ranked, strictly following the WBF Evaluation Guidelines. As a result, 60 best ranking projects were selected and they were further evaluated by the WBF Evaluation Committee, which prepared the List of Recommended Projects, to be further approved/endorsed by the WBF CSO and WBF Conference of MFA.

WBF SECOND CALL IN FIGURES



245

application received



911

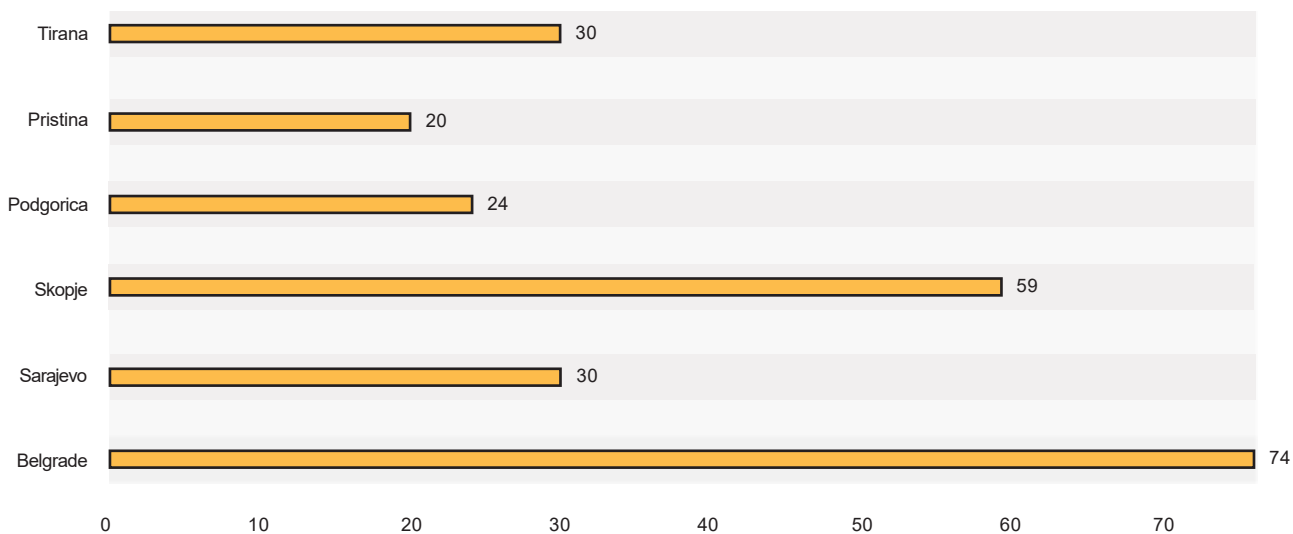
organisations participated
in the Call



3,72

average partners per
application

Allocation per Contracting Party



1

EUR 260.000
offered through
the Call

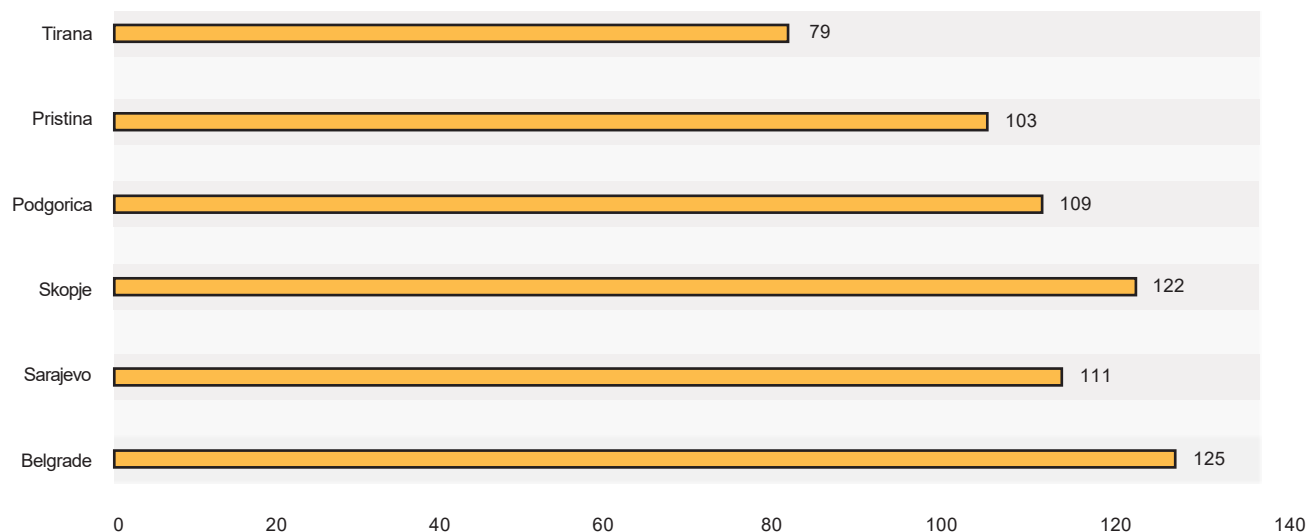
3

4 Million EUR -
Total cost of the
projects

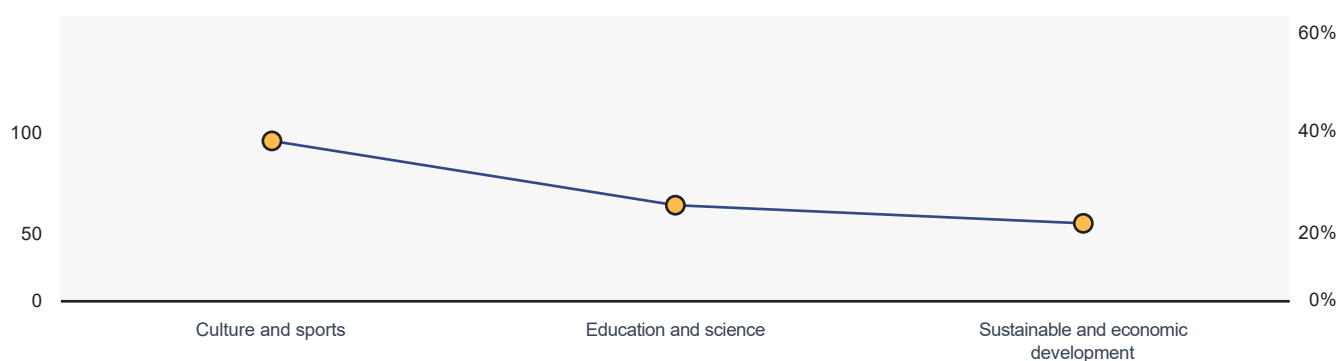
2

2.8 Million EUR
- Total amount
requested from
WBF

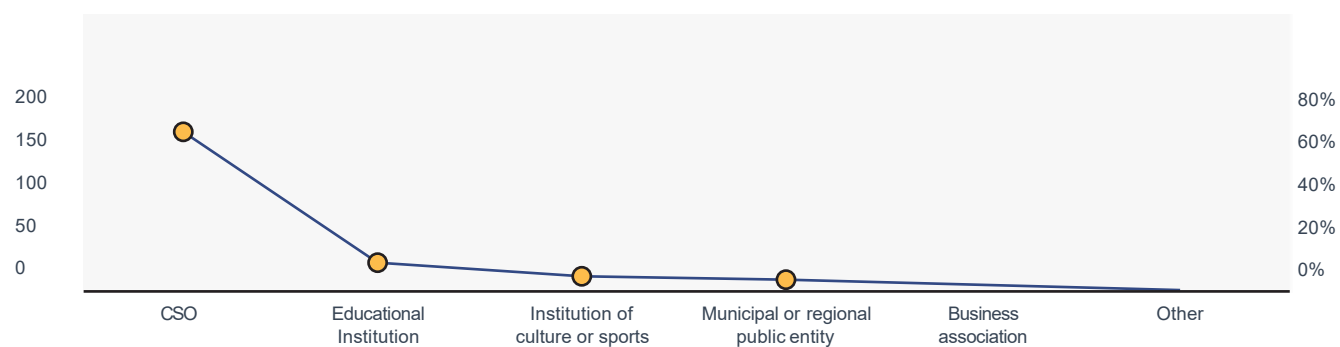
Allocation of partnership per Contracting Party



Allocation per area of intervention



Allocation per type of applicant



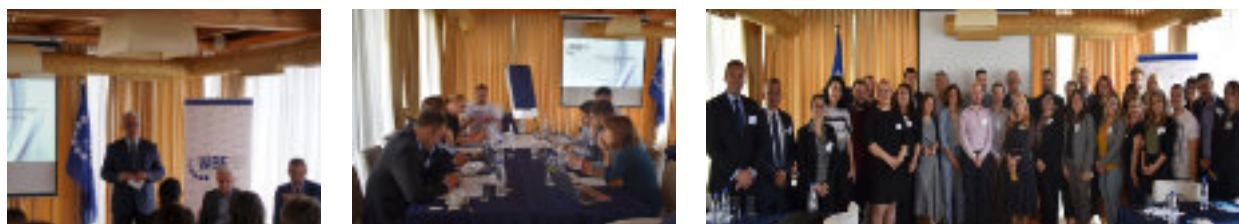
Awarding Ceremony

WBF upon the completion of the evaluation process in April 2019 published the list of awarded projects. The next event, was Partnership Workshop and Awarding Ceremony, that gathered 25 grantees, together with representatives of Ministries of Foreign Affairs and other partners from all around the region, taking place on 25-26 of May 2019.

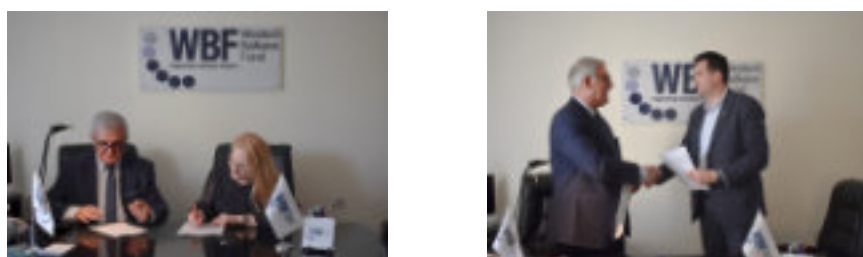


The aim of the Partnership Workshop was to fine-tune the upcoming processes in order to ensure a smooth cooperation, while implementing WBF supported projects.

During the Workshop representatives of the winning organizations were divided by areas of intervention of their projects, like: cultural cooperation, education and scientific research and sustainable development, and were instructed by WBF team with all the necessary information needed during the implementation phase, as monitoring, reporting, timeline and financial/budgetary procedures.



At the end of the Workshop, the Contracts Signing Ceremony was also organized at the WBF Headquarters, symbolizing the actual starting of the project's implementation.





CULTURE 122 applications

(40% OF APPLICATIONS)

Culture and sports have been recognized as the areas which have great potential for regional cooperation. They are not only vital to the overall societal development, but have a significant advantage in serving as a multiplier effect to reach far more people than those who directly participate in sports and/or cultural events. It is also perceived that cultural events specifically are highly valuable in affecting regional cooperation, as the region shares a lot of cultural and traditional values that could bring people closer together.

PROMOTION OF CULTURAL AND NATURAL DIVERSITY

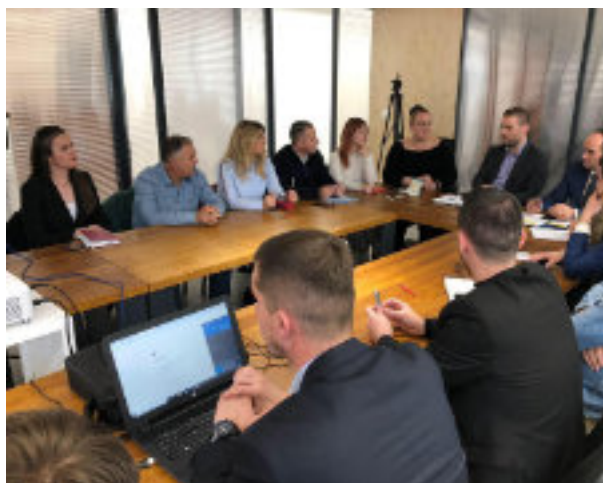
Municipality of Ferizaj

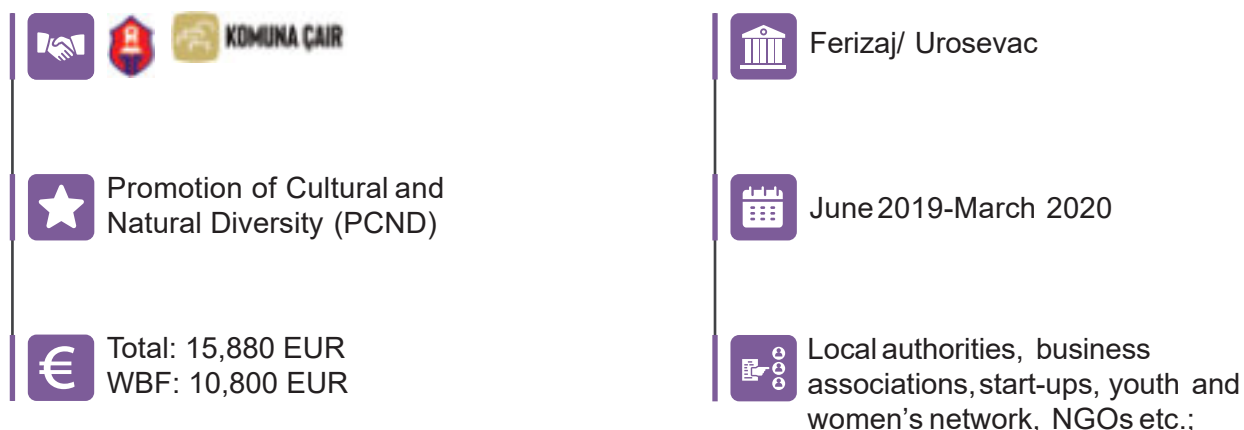


INTRODUCTION: Municipality of Ferizaj/Urosevac is one of the biggest municipalities in Kosovo* and it is well known for its rich intangible cultural heritage where religions are endorsed as one good without any distinctions. Municipality of Ferizaj/Urosevac is interested to learn from its neighbours how to better promote its natural and cultural heritage that could bring more visitors, but also put Ferizaj in the map as a next tourist destination. All three partners agreed to apply with a joint regional initiative to share experiences in protecting and promoting natural diversity in three municipalities. Local authorities involved in this project have addressed the regional cooperation element from the local perspective, aiming to contribute in a regional outlook, knowing that Western Balkans territories offer a huge potential for nature-based tourism, which is not being explored and used yet. All three municipalities aim to increase the trends in tourism sector, through raising awareness activities, knowing that promotion of tourism, culture and natural heritage is important to improve social cohesion and enhance economic growth prospects for Montenegro, North Macedonia and Kosovo*.

OBJECTIVES: To support sustainable economic growth through regional community building linkages, strengthening regional business initiatives and networking in the WB region; To increase regional activities using promotion of cultural and natural heritage as a tool for dialogue and enhance joint initiatives; and strengthen the competitiveness and sustainability of regional initiatives; To strengthen social cohesion through tourism promotion, integrated cultural and natural heritage support services.

RESULTS: Increased cooperation among municipalities on promotion of cultural and natural heritage; Selected monuments/sites from the Prioritised Intervention List are promoted and some sites were used for capacity development activities; Increased awareness of the Municipality of Ferizaj/Urosevac, Municipality of Cetinje and Municipality of Cair population on the importance of Cultural and Natural





CULTURE, A COMMON LANGUAGE OF SOCIO-ECONOMICAL RELATIONS

Regional Arts and Culture Centre of Korca

INTRODUCTION: The aim of the project “Culture – a Common Language of Socio -Economical Relations (CCLOSER) was to bring together young artists from the region and give them the platform to showcase their abilities and talents through joint theatre play. The play was written by a Serbian writer, was directed by a Macedonian stage director and played by young actors from the region. Main focus of the theatre play were similarities in cultural heritage and social links, emphasizing the fact that current realities are affecting us the same. It points out that besides the language differences and history, the nations that are living close to each other for very long time do share common values and still they do have common issues to tackle with joint approach.

OBJECTIVES: To increase institutional cooperation with specific focus on youth engagement towards promoting regional cooperation and social cohesion; Encourage transnational circulation of artistic and cultural works (identifying common social values in the three countries) which in turn encourage dialogue and social cohesion; Increase cities' own responsibility towards regional cooperation

IMPACT: 20 young people engaged as actors and support people and more than 1500 as audience; A joint plan of cooperation between the theatre troupes of the three cities; A theatre exchange program in place as part of these institutions' annual plan; A sustainable cooperation created and increased awareness of communities on the importance of cultural exchange; on how to better improve the conditions for tourism in these three locations.



ZVEZDARA TEATAR
 1917 Uspomena na otvaranje - Zvezdara
 1917 Center for culture - Belgrade



Culture – a Common Language of Socio-Economical Relations (CCLOSER)”



Total: 15,600 EUR
 WBF 12,000 EUR



Korca



May 2019 – March 2020



WB communities which through exchange of art and culture works came closer together, set grounds and improved cultural relations recognizing strong similarities and benefitting from diversity with the aim to work together towards EU integration objectives.



STREETART IN THE BALKANS 2

KOM18



INTRODUCTION: Club for Youth Empowerment (KOM 018) from Serbia implemented the project "Street art in the Balkans2" in consortia with "Red Cross Novo Sarajevo" from Bosnia and Herzegovina, "New Vision" from Albania, "SPPMD" (Council for prevention of juvenile delinquency) from North Macedonia and "Spirit art Montenegro" from Montenegro. Project engaged and built capacities of young

hip hop artists with support of their senior and well recognized colleagues through organization of regional street art festival "Dodji na Amfi" (Come to Amfi) supporting young artists and building the audience for performers.

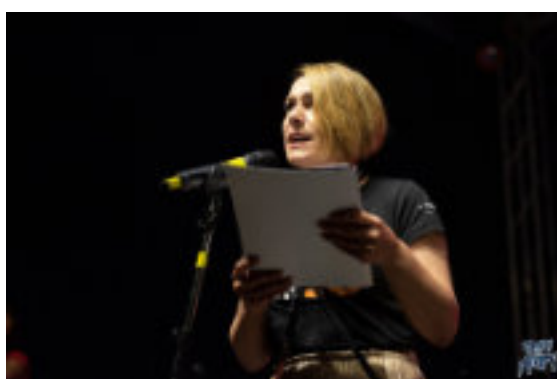
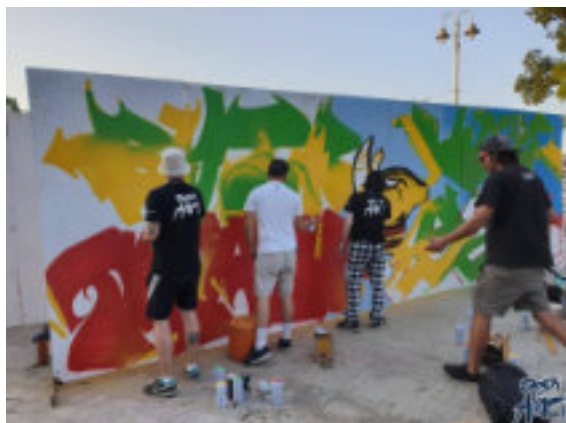
Supported by the WBF and IVF, young hip hop artists from the WB6 and V4 (Poland, Czech Republic and Hungary) region had a chance to improve their knowledge and skills via master classes and workshops provided, but also to express their art works and talents in different forms of a hip hop culture - hip hop music, hip hop and break dance, beat boxing, video, photography, basket 1:1.

OBJECTIVES: To recognize hip hop culture as the bond between the young people from Balkan region (Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, North Macedonia, Montenegro and Serbia) and provide young people with building of their competences, skills and knowledge to become recognized on the regional level, and an opportunity of the exchange between the hip hop cultural players in the region both already established artists and those who are at the beginning of their careers.

RESULTS: Master classes and workshops conducted in beat making, rap music and entrepreneurship, hip hop dance, photography, video production, graffiti drawing for 40 participants from WB6 and V4 region; 48 young people competed in hip hop dance and basketball 1:1 battles, and over 70 youngsters performed in 2 types of showcasing; over 1,000 photos and 2 videos on festival and "The impressions..." of participants published at "Dodji na Amfi" Youtube channel; 30 well recognized artists (from Serbia, Bosnia and Herzegovina, North Macedonia, and France), and 30 less recognized artist from Serbia performed or exhibited their works; over 100 volunteers recruited to support the implementation of festival; over 10,000 visitors to the festival.

Opportunity provided for young people from the WB6 and also the V4 region to connect and network, create and perform together in different hip hop culture disciplines which altogether directly contributes to erasing of stereotypes and prejudices that exists among young people from the region and promoting positive social values via hip hop culture.





"Street art in the Balkans2"



Total: 16,650 EUR
WBF: 6,000 EUR



Niš



June 2019-October 2019



Young hip hop culture artists,
cultural institutions and
organizations, youth

STRENGTHENING REGIONAL COOPERATION & DIALOGUE ON LGBTI RIGHTS IN WESTERN BALKANS

LGBTI Equal Rights Association for Western Balkans and Turkey – ERA

ERA INTRODUCTION: LGBTI Equal Rights Association for Western Balkans and Turkey – ERA from Serbia implemented the project “Strengthening regional cooperation and dialogue on LGBTI rights in the WB”, in consortia with Alliance against Discrimination from Albania, Coalition Sexual and Health Rights of Marginalized Communities MARGINS from North Macedonia, Da Se Zna from Serbia, Centre for Equality and Liberty for LGBT community in Kosovo* from Kosovo*, Association Spektra from Montenegro and Tuzla Open Center from Bosnia and Herzegovina. In partnership with its 6 member organizations from Albania and 1 partner organization from Netherlands, ERA hosted its 4th Regional Conference “Our right, your future” held in Tirana on 6-9 November 2019. Followed by the comprehensive program sessions with national and international stakeholders along with the “TransBalkan” photography exhibition of Aleksandar Crnogorac, the 4th conference focused on issues and legal and policy advancement of the LGBTI community from our region. The conference was supported by different donors among which were Western Balkans Fund, European Commission, Norwegian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Embassy of the Kingdom of the Netherlands in Albania, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Kingdom of the Netherlands, Europe House, Give Out UK and Open Society Foundation and Regional Youth Cooperation Office.

OBJECTIVE: Strengthening of regional dialogue and cooperation among decision makers on protection and advancement of the rights of LGBTI persons, and increase of political will and engagement of state institutions on effective protection and advancement of LGBTI rights. Moreover, project focused on improvement of regional dialogue, exchange and cooperation among LGBTI activists and other stakeholders, and visibility of LGBTI community in WB region (especially in Albania) and Turkey.

RESULTS: At least 5 policy recommendations developed and integrated in the conference conclusion paperwork through co-support provided for accommodation of 31 representatives of the LGBTI community organizations, and part of translation for the annual conference realization. Developed policy recommendations are part of the Annual LGBTI Enlargement Review 2019, compiled by ILGA-Europe and ERA, together with its member organizations.

ERA Annual conference outlined developments and challenges of the LGBTI community and also advocated for overcoming gaps in legislation and policy. Conference is a regional and partnership building platform which contributes to a promotion and protection of the human rights of the LGBTI and strengthening of a dialogue and exchange of best practices among governmental and non-governmental stakeholders of the Western Balkans and Turkey region.





Stichting Art 1, Netherlands



Belgrade



Strengthening regional cooperation and dialogue on LGBTI rights in the Western Balkans



September 2019-March 2020



Total: 6,250 EUR
WBF: 5,000 EUR



LGBTI persons from WB, LGBTI movement operating in WB6, Governments, members of the LGBTI inter-governmental working group of WB

GASTRONOMIC MAP OF WESTERN BALKANS

Generator



INTRODUCTION: Generator from Serbia implemented the project “Gastronomic map of Western Balkans” in consortia with ARNO from Skopje, Bona Fide from Pljevlja (Podgorica) and KCIC from Prishtina. The project addresses enabling environment for regional cooperation, promotion and preservation of common gastronomic heritage as a tool to connect WB6 people who love and practice traditional cooking and present

similarities in an innovative way; and this was done through conducting and documenting cooking and degustation events in the respective WB6 region, and publishing their results and produces online along with the WB Cookbook – consisting of recipes of the WB6 people’s favourite and traditional dishes.

OBJECTIVES: To strengthen regional (gastronomic) identity through an increase of the awareness of similarities of traditional cuisine in the WB region through connecting people who are differently engaged in traditional cooking, and therefore to raise the awareness and contribute to the promotion and preservation of a common gastronomic heritage.

RESULTS: 7 cooking events conducted with 68 participants and 4 degustation events with 161 participants from the WB6 region; events followed by 103 photos and 11 videos made along with 116 recipes collected; 1600 food led postcards distributed in the region; 1 crowd-funding event conducted - 117 people from all over the world donated for 3 more cooking events in the region; networking within the region made with 8 CSO, 14 food led entrepreneurs, 2 education led stakeholders; 600 copies of a Cookbook printed and distributed to different stakeholders in the region.

Connecting people who love and practice traditional cooking and food related chain stakeholders in the WB6 region as a tool for regional cooperation and also increase of the awareness and promotion of a common gastronomic heritage in the WB6 region.



Gastronomic map of Western Balkans



Total: 15,848.80 EUR
WBF: 11,000 EUR



Vranje



June 2019-April 2020



Unemployed youth, cooking trainees, victims of domestic violence, women from rural areas who work on preserving heritage, women and rural development associations, food supply and processing chains

WESTERN BALKANS WOMEN PEACE TALKS

Foundation Jelena Santic



INTRODUCTION: Foundation Jelena Šantić from Serbia implemented the project “Western Balkans Women Peace Talks”, in consortia with Foundation CURE from Bosnia and Herzegovina and Center for Research and Gender Policy from Kosovo*. The project initiated encounters and exchange between women peace activists and artists from Sarajevo, Prishtina and Belgrade where these encounters become focal points and continually contribute to the cooperation of the three societies to improve social, political and cultural relationships. This was done through “peace talks” organized in a form of an open panel during the three following, well established festivals: FEMART in Prishtina, Pitchwise in Sarajevo, and BEFEM in Belgrade. An added value of the project, and in addition to the Jelena Santic Brave steps national awarding ceremony, is the introduction of the Jelena Santic Brave steps regional awarding when two awards given to the Forgotten children of war and women’s group the Rebellious readers.

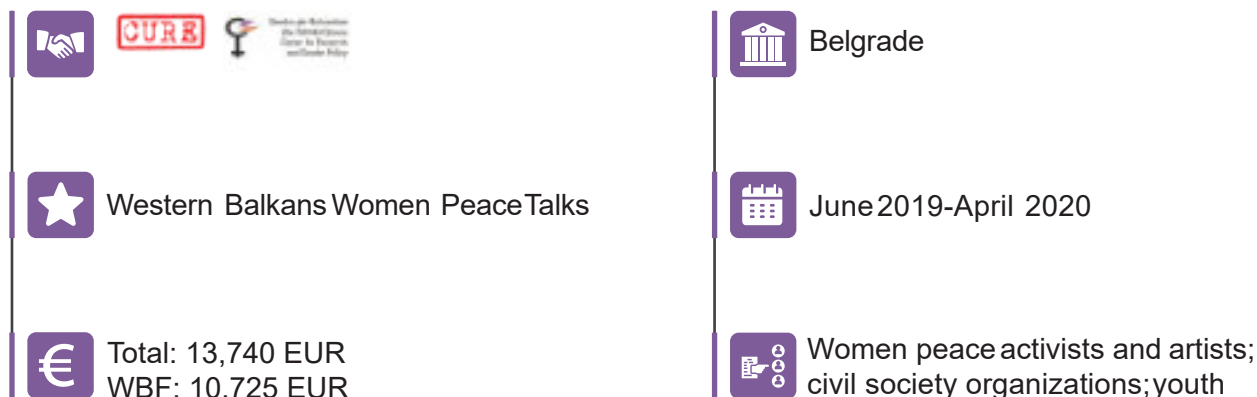
OBJECTIVE: To expand a space for regional dialogue about peacebuilding and conflict resolution from women’s perspective and initiate of encounters and exchange between women peace activists and artists from Sarajevo, Prishtina and Belgrade.

RESULTS: Three topic led women peace talks realized for up to over 280 participants during FemArt, Pitch Wise and BEFEM festivals, as follows: “Intergenerational dialogue on feminist activism in (post) Yugoslavspace”, “Art forms and combat for gender equality”; “Women’s activism – what stimulates our activism”.

Two regional awards awarded, and awarding ceremony conducted via social media when awarding ceremony video published.

Enabling expanding a space for regional dialogue about peace-building and conflict resolution from women’s perspective and initiate of encounters and exchange between women peace activists and artists from Sarajevo, Prishtina and Belgrade. Moreover, the project contributes to the cooperation of these societies to improve social, political and cultural relationships.





ROMAN HERITAGE IN THE BALKANS

Association DIGI.BA



INTRODUCTION: Association DIGI.BA gathers top experts coming from different fields including computer graphics, informatics, culture, cultural management, cultural tourism, and marketing, all of them having several successful projects in the field of digitalization and visualization of cultural heritage behind. Western Balkans area was part of the Roman Empire, therefore today we have a lot of remains and archaeological sites all over the region. However, when visiting those settlements and cultural monuments, it is difficult to imagine how they looked like originally or their functions. Virtual reality (VR) and ICT technologies offer possibility to take visitors and Internet users to time travel in the past. Four selected cultural sites from the BiH, Serbia, Montenegro and Albania, partners' countries, corresponding documentation and relevant exhibits will be digitized in detail or modelled using advanced techniques; these environments enable the user of the application to make virtual walks through sites and objects, interacting with them to obtain detailed information and following virtual guides-storytellers. Using virtual environments for cultural heritage presentation enhances the perception of the sites, which are now in reality just a set of remains.

OBJECTIVES: The project supported by Western Balkans Fund aimed to increase awareness and knowledge about the Roman presence in partners Countries of Western Balkans, to create a user-friendly web-application, which allows interactive virtual visits within selected sites and listening to relevant explanations and to give a boost to tourism especially cultural.

RESULTS: Studies on selected Roman sites and on their importance. In order to create the interactive multimedia presentation of selected sites, experts of Roman history in partners' countries provided relevant information and research's results for the implementation of story-telling. Creation of interactive 3D models of four sites and their structures. Interactive multimedia presentation consists of 3D models of sites, buildings and objects, combined in an interactive web presentation, enabling the user to virtually walk through the objects and watch the movies describing the elements of each site.

Creation of digital stories. In this project project's experts created VR digital stories about selected elements of four Roman sites in accordance with the prepared scenarios and using information and data from experts. Installation and testing in the museums. Visitors can experience virtual visits using VR setup if available or navigate using a pc.

This project managed to involve Museums managers as much as possible since the very beginning of project's implementation, envisaging provision of equipment and software in order to help them to increase their offer of virtual exhibitions. Furthermore, with the project, Digi.ba, together with their partners continue supporting 3D digitization and virtual reconstruction of cultural heritage, specifically in common among Contracting Parties in the Region.



Roman heritage in the Balkans



Total: 15,900 EUR
WBF: 12,000 EUR



Sarajevo



May 2019 – January 2020



Cultural tourists, visitors of Roman sites in Western Balkans. Researchers in cultural heritage through internet and students.



“CHALLENGE HISTORY 3 – REACT FOR THE FUTURE”

Helsinki Committee for Human Rights of the Republic of North Macedonia

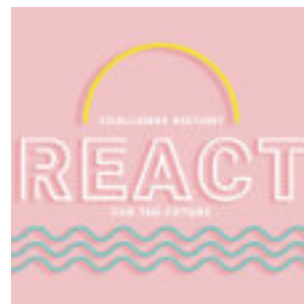
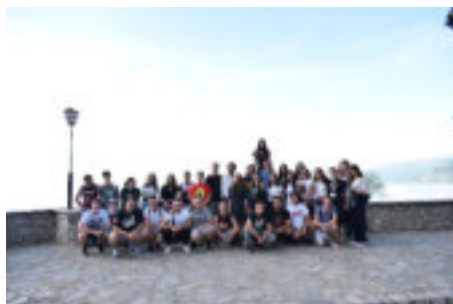


INTRODUCTION: The Helsinki Committee for Human Rights of the Republic of North Macedonia is a civic association registered in 1994. The Committee monitors the situation with human rights, provides legal assistance, co-operates with other organizations and state bodies for the purpose of improving the promotion, respect and protection of human rights and freedoms. The Committee's goal is protection and promotion of the human rights and freedoms guaranteed with the Constitution of the Republic of North Macedonia, the international instruments and the Helsinki Final Act from 1975, as well as building democratic conditions in which they can be exercised based on the rule of law. The Committee sets off from the premise that all people should have the possibility to enjoy and practice their basic rights and freedoms and should be able to protect them in case of violation or limitation. This is the basis of the rule of law, human rights and democracy.

OBJECTIVES:: “ChallengeHistory 3 – Reactfor the Future” Follow up project is focused on supporting youth activists, change agents in their communities in constructing and nurturing new Balkan connections, by strengthening youth activists and giving them the opportunity to gain knowledge and skills for sustainable peacebuilding. The project encourages already willing and active youth to challenge history and work towards a peaceful European future. Secondly, by providing supportive environment for constructive dialogue, learning and spreading information on shared history in the WB, the project aims at redefining regional cooperation and building up regional identity.

The mentioned objectives were met by the implementation of the “ChallengeHistory 3 – Reactfor the Future” SummerSchool and follow up activities. The ChallengeHistory – REACTfor the future project, in its third edition was coordinated by the lead applicant Helsinki Committee for Human Rights in North Macedonia, together with partner organizations from Serbia (Serbian Helsinki Committee for Human Rights) Montenegro (Grammar School Slobodan Skerovich) Bosnia and Herzegovina (War childhood Museum and United World College Mostar) and Kosovo* (Democracy + and Centre for Peace and Tolerance).

RESULTS: This project managed to equip youth peace-building activists with knowledge and skills to disseminate concepts of inter-sectionalist, multiculturalism and antidiscrimination for supporting lasting peace-building and sustainable cooperation among the youth of the region. Regional network of youth peace-building activists advocating for critical thinking and constructive debate on the future of WB in Europe through continuous creative activism is establish. This project managed to involve Museums managers as much as possible since the very beginning of project's implementation, envisaging provision of equipment and software in order to help them to increase their offer of virtual exhibitions. Furthermore, with the project, Digi.ba, together with their partners continue supporting 3D digitization and virtual reconstruction of cultural heritage, specifically in common among Contracting Parties in the Region.



CPT
Center for Peace and Tolerance
WAR CHILDHOOD MUSEUM



Gimnazija „Slobodan Stanić“



Helsinki Committee for Human Rights of the Republic of North Macedonia



Total: 41,085 EUR
WBF: 10,940 EUR



Skopje



May 2019 – February 2020



30 youth peace-building activists & peer educators from Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo*, Republic of North Macedonia, Montenegro, and Republic of Serbia; 500 participants at public events, secondary school students and teachers, in at least 5 local communities in the Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo*, Republic of North Macedonia, Montenegro, and Republic of Serbia.

TRAVELING CINEMA

Makedox



INTRODUCTION: MakeDox is an organization which works on promotion of documentary films and filmmakers while providing education to all interested in this art form. Traveling Cinema was a film caravan that has visited numerous cross border villages around Ohrid Lake and showcased films from recent regional production. As a part of caravan, the DocuCamp was organized. During the camp, young filmmakers from the region had an opportunity to improve their skills and to learn how to promote values of active citizenship, good governance and good neighborly cooperation through visual expression.

OBJECTIVES: The project supported by Western Balkans Fund aimed to stimulate creation, preservation and circulation of creative documentary films that present and preserve cultural heritage of the WB6 region and to educate young artists on how to internalize values of active citizenship, good governance and neighborly cooperation through visual expression.

RESULTS: Seven screenings of regional films have been organized which generated over 800 visitors and understanding of how to use visual expression as a tool for promotion of common regional values is increased.

Increased promotion of cross-border cooperation, intercultural dialogue and good neighborly relations through art and raised awareness for the need to have more decentralized cultural events.





THREE QUEENS STORY

City Museum of Zenica

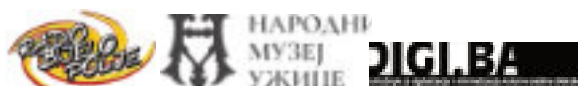
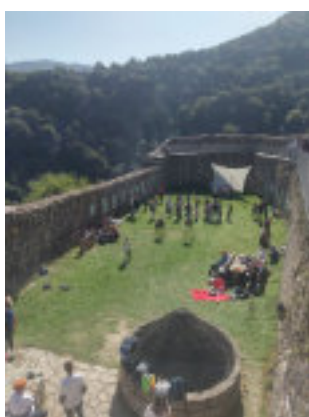


INTRODUCTION: City Museum of Zenica is a cultural institution which main activities are researching, preserving, collecting and processing museum material. Zenica City Museum implemented their project in the region, but the main activity, Medieval Festival took place at The Old town Vranduk, which

for centuries known as the hardest part of Bosnia, the gate of Bosnia, is placed 14 kilometres on the west of Zenica, on a route to Doboj. It was built on a sheer rock above the river Bosnia.

OBJECTIVE: The project supported by Western Balkans Fund aimed to increase the positive influence of medieval heritage as a common value of the countries involved in the project through various project activities, to strengthen opportunities to bond among artists from the region through travel and joint projects and to extend the knowledge of the local population about the specific cultural heritage and the important role of women in it through printed books thematic exhibitions.

RESULTS: This project managed to involve Museums managers, envisaging provision of equipment and software in order to help them to increase their offer of virtual exhibitions. Furthermore, with the project, Digi.ba, together with their partners continue supporting 3D digitization and virtual reconstruction of cultural heritage, specifically in common among Contracting Parties in the Region.



Three queens' story



Total: 15,132.08 EUR
WBF: 10,795 EUR



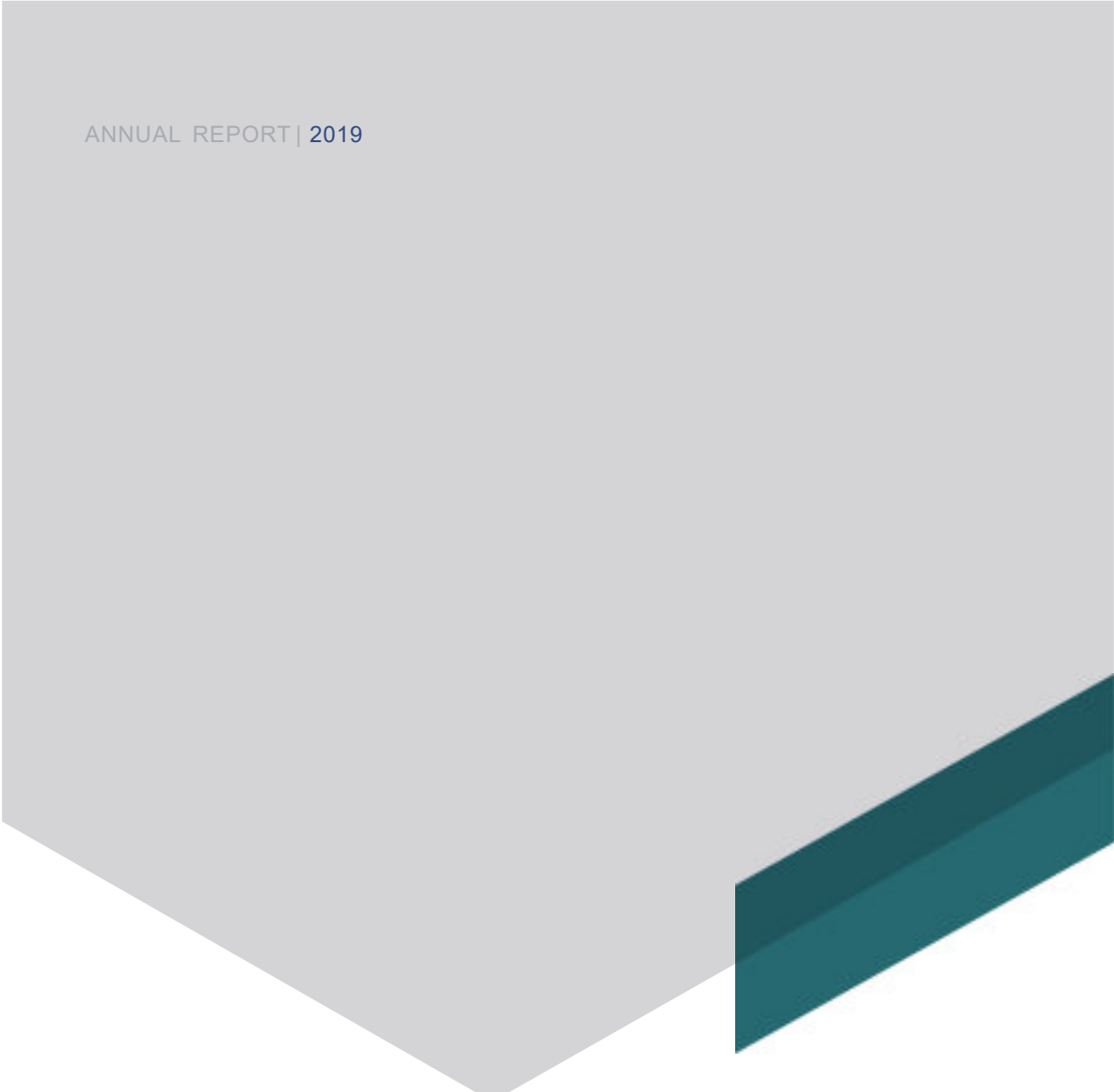
Zenica



June 2019 – November 2019



Artists of all ages; school children; students;



EDUCATION & SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH

66 applications

(32% OF TOTAL WBF 2'ND CALL PROJECTS)

WBF's second area of intervention aims to inspire change within the region by creating positive impact through partnerships among academia level. From research to educational exchange, education to innovation, our area of focus offers the opportunity to dramatically improve the quality of knowledge for people of Western Balkans region, with a focus on building long-lasting partnerships that bring together resources, expertise, and vision. In our view, this area has a strong potential for the future, aiming to increase the mobility and connectivity of students, researchers and academic institutions and staff in the region.

PROMOTING FREEDOM OF EXPRESSION IN WESTERN BALKANS

Kosovar Institute for Media and Communication



INTRODUCTION: is a young organization established by professional journalists and media professionals to contribute in supporting transparent journalism in Kosovo* also to protect and promote freedom of speech. While their partner Civil Alliance - Gradjanska Alijansa from Montenegro is one of organizations that successfully continues to support citizens in defending their civil and human rights, assisting them in overcoming the

problems of poor institutional cooperation and inappropriate interpretation of legal norms as well as tardiness and lack of responsibility of individual civil servants. Second partner in this project is Balkan Institute for Regional Cooperation – BIRC is non-governmental and non-partisan, fully independent in its operations, based in Tetovo and is committed to promoting and practicing quality journalism and scientific. All three partners came to an agreement to work in a joint initiative whose aim was to emphasize importance of media freedom for establishing fully democratic societies in the Western Balkans; how the media should be vocal about government actions and policies that diminish this freedom as well as increase awareness on media freedom which needs to be given more importance within the EU accession process. Within this initiative were organized local workshops/trainings and regional conference that enhanced capacities of journalists in the region and to tackle the burning issues in each contracting party such as: investigative journalism, standards on defamation and self-censorship; fake news and hate speech.

OBJECTIVES: To develop professionalism, responsibility and respect of ethical rules among journalist in WB region; To promote freedom of expression and freedom of the media as well as access to information in WB region; To develop higher quality journalism, and a pluralistic media landscape in WB region.

RESULTS: Increased numbers of individual journalist's capacities on hate speech; To enhance awareness on rights and responsibilities of journalists. Journalists and editor's knowledge on how to make difference between freedom of expression and violation of right to privacy; At least one informal network of journalists to enhance regional dialogue is developed.

All three partners through this initiative helped to learn more about each other in terms of freedom of speech and problems that are present in all three contracting parties related to media and communication. Within the project were organized three events that gathered over 200 participants from the region such as media professionals, journalists and students where numerous of topics were discussed and elaborated.





Promoting Freedom of Expression in Western Balkans



Total: 13,200 EUR
WBF: 10,700 EUR



Prishtina



June 2019 - December 2019



Public authorities, broadcasting regulatory bodies, media self-regulatory bodies, public-service broadcaster, media professionals, representatives of NGO sector, journalists and students;

EUROPEAN INTEGRATION OF THE WB: MAKING A REALISTIC PERSPECTIVE OUT OF A SHIFTING TARGET

Albanian Institute for International Studies



ALBANIAN INSTITUTE FOR
INTERNATIONAL STUDIES

INTRODUCTION: The project “European integration of the WB: making a realistic perspective out of a shifting target” aimed to assess the impact of 2019 events, (Brexit, EU elections) over integration perspective of the WB. The project gathered three organizations with experience in EU integration research and produced 3 policy briefs that assessed the situation in light of the recent challenges.

OBJECTIVES: To assess the impact of 2019 events, (Brexit, EU elections) over integration perspective of the WB countries and contribute to the process positively; to nourish a positive debate about integration and to advocate jointly as a region;

IMPACT: Accurate, updated and relevant knowledge and information about integration process; Joint regional advocacy for accession; Informed public debate that aided popular support for EU path;



European integration of the WB: making a realistic perspective out of a shifting target



Total: 15,350.00 EUR
WBF: 12,000 EUR



Tirana



May 2019 – March 2020



National stakeholders of integration (government, parliament, civil society, media, youth) ; EU decision makers in the area of enlargement; regional organizations (RCC, WBF, RYCO, etc.)

INTERNSHIPS OF YOUNG RESEARCHERS TO MIGRATION THINK TANKS IN WESTERN BALKANS

Centre for Economic and Social Studies



INTRODUCTION: The “Internships of young researchers to migration think tanks in Western Balkans (Albania, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Montenegro and Serbia)” project aims to provide access to migration think tanks research institutions. Through the internship young researcher can gain access to data and mentorship at participating/partner organizations, which will increase impact in terms of research produced and network established. Interns participating in this program will exercise and develop many skills during the course of the project and improve the research protocols that are methodologically sound and can support policy changes.

OBJECTIVES: To increase knowledge and skills of interns in migration studies through practical training, mentorship and support supervision; To enhance more regional cooperation through building capacity on migration studies by having mutual access to regular national data collection, data analysis and reporting; To establish an innovative, capacity building and skills, and knowledge sharing network in Western Balkans.

IMPACT: Increased regional cooperation on migration studies amongst think tanks in Albania, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Montenegro and Serbia; Better opportunity to share knowledge and ideas with professionals in the migration and development field and professional development of both the interns and host institutions.



Tirana



Internships of young researchers to migration think tanks in Western Balkans (Albania, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Montenegro and Serbia)



May 2019 - ongoing



Total: 16,250.00 EUR
WBF: 11,450 EUR



Think tank organizations on migration policy research; university and research centers in WB6 region

WESTERN BALKANS YOUTH WATER POLO CUP 2019

Swimming Water Polo Club Jadran



INTRODUCTION: Swimming Water polo club Jadran is one of the oldest sport institutions in Montenegro with the equally long tradition in education. Western Balkans Water polo Cup 2019 gathered over 80 youth players and coaches from WB region with the aim to enhance cooperation among water polo clubs, water polo and swimming federations and exchange the best practices among sport professionals and youth players.

OBJECTIVES: This project aimed to strengthen cooperation among clubs, water polo federations and relevant sport institutions while providing youth players with the opportunity to improve their skills and to learn how to work in multicultural environment.

RESULTS: With the support of Western Balkans Fund, SWC Jadran has managed to improve sport and intercultural skills of over 80 youth players through hands on and informative activities and increased professional cooperation between swimming and water polo institutions from Western Balkans region. Enhanced youth interaction through sports and increased professional cooperation between swimming and water polo institutions from Western Balkans region and increased public awareness of the benefits of regional cooperation as a tool for social development.










Western Balkans Youth Water polo Cup 2019



Total: 23,500 EUR
WBF: 10,800 EUR



Herceg Novi



May 2019 – December 2019



80 young water polo players from WB region; partner clubs; swimming and water polo federations from Montenegro, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Serbia and North Macedonia; local community

WRITING AS A TOOL FOR INTERCULTURAL DIALOGUE

NGO PUNKT



INTRODUCTION: PUNKT is a non-profit organization which serves as a platform for young artists from different spheres to promote their work and to raise awareness to most burning questions in the field of culture and cultural cooperation. Writing as a tool for intercultural dialogue provided young non-acclaimed artists from the region with the opportunity to enhance their writing skills through workshops and close mentorship, while discussing interculturalism and how it can be used as an effective tool in literature.

OBJECTIVES: The aim of this project was to promote regional writing practices as a set of knowledge and skills that are inherently based on the principles of intercultural dialogue.

RESULTS: The cooperation among writers from the region is increased and the network has been created. The collection of short stories created as a result of Summer Writing Camp was published and promoted throughout the region.

By supporting this project Western Balkans Fund has contributed to increase of use of intercultural dialogue through art and cooperation among young writers from WB region.



Writing as a tool for intercultural dialogue



Total: 14,500 EUR
WBF: 11,400 EUR



Podgorica



May 2019 – January 2020



Writers and artists from Montenegro, Kosovo*, Serbia and North Macedonia; NGOs from the field of culture; local communities

COMBATING SOCIAL EXCLUSION OF YOUNG PEOPLE

The Centre for Youth Activism KRIK



INTRODUCTION: The Centre for Youth Activism KRIK is a non-governmental, non-profit organization established and led by young people while working for and with young people. The mission of KRIK is the empowerment of youth by motivating them to raise their voices and actively contribute to their society. KRIK supports youth work and youth workers by engaging in different areas in order to achieve greater youth participation, youth activism, and involvement in policy-making processes at local and national levels.

OBJECTIVES: In Western Balkan region people with disabilities are facing a lot of problems. Within this project, regional activities manage to be made in which youth with and without disabilities learned from each other and learned about cultural cooperation while increasing the number of educational-mobility activities. Moreover, youth workers gained knowledge and built their capacities in working in mixed groups, so indirectly the capacities of the organization included in this project were fostered. Best practices and ways of working with mixed groups were shared and tested. The Challenge History – REACT for the future project, in its third edition was coordinated by the lead applicant Helsinki Committee for Human Rights in North Macedonia, together with partner organizations from Serbia (Serbian Helsinki Committee for Human Rights) Montenegro (Grammar School Slobodan Skerovich) Bosnia and Herzegovina (War childhood Museum and United World College Mostar) and Kosovo* (Democracy + and Centre for Peace and Tolerance).

RESULTS: The participants with and without disabilities, coming from WB6 are willing to continue with the next joint event, they are willing to work more together on achieving social inclusion, the youth workers are interested in implementing integrative youth programs on local level and the project partners are more interested in Regional Cooperation projects and networking with organizations from WB6 region.



  	 Skopje/Ohrid
 Combating social exclusion of young people	 May 2019 – December 2019
 Total: 14,890 EUR WBF: 11,939 EUR	 Youth Workers, Young people with and without disabilities;

SUMMER SCHOOL “DATA ANALYSIS FOR PUBLIC POLICY”

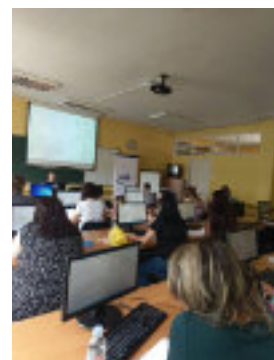
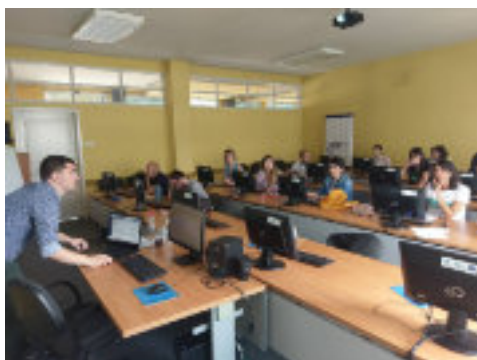
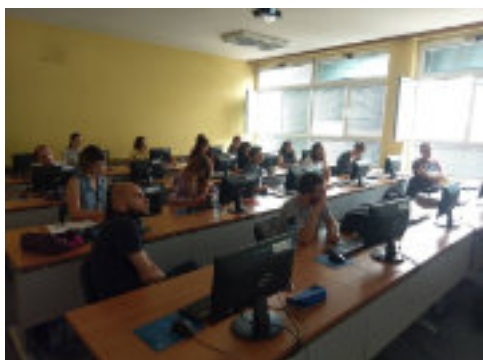
The School of Economics and Business in Sarajevo (SEBS)



INTRODUCTION: The School of Economics and Business in Sarajevo (SEBS) was established in 1952 as the Faculty of Economics. Its first class consisted of 105 full-time and 129 part-time students. SEBS has the longest tradition and is the largest educational institution in Bosnia and Herzegovina. SEBS has been a member of European Foundation for Management Development - EFMD and member of The Association to Advance Collegiate School of Business – AACSB.

OBJECTIVES: : The project supported by Western Balkans Fund aimed to train students, junior academics and public policy employees from the region to engage in robust economic debate and to support capacity building and mobility of academic institutions in the region.

RESULTS: The project improved research potential for evidence based public policy in the region, promoted the best practices of education policies and shared the best performances among academic institutions. This project improved institutional capacity of government agency to enhance data driven decision-making process within region.



FINANCE THINK
Economic
Research &
Policy
Institute



Summer School "Data Analysis for Public Policy"



Total: 11,950 EUR
WBF: 10,000 EUR



Sarajevo



June 2019 – October 2019



Graduate students; junior academics;
public sector employees

"BALKAN-THE CROSSROADS OF CIVILIZATIONS"

RESPONSIBLE HISTORY EDUCATION AS A TOOL FOR STRENGTHENING COOPERATION IN THE REGION

EuroClio BiH

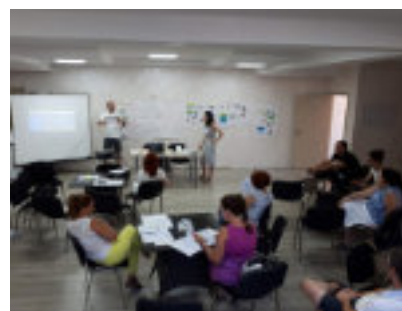


INTRODUCTION: EuroClio BiH was established in 2003 with the support of the EuroClio Europe. Main objective of this institution is to improve History teaching all around Bosnia and Herzegovina. Within the second public call of the Western Balkan Foundation (<http://westernbalkansfund.org>), the History Teachers Association in Bosnia and Herzegovina EUROCLIOHIP BiH is launching awarded project called „Balkan – the Crossroads of Civilizations. “Responsible history education as a tool for strengthening cooperation in the region”. EUROCLIOHIP BiH is implementing project in partnership with history teachers' associations from Serbia – UDI Euroclio, Montenegro – HIP MONT, North Macedonia – ANIM, Kosovo* - SHMHK and Albania – ALBNA.

History teaching in WB countries has an important place in education system and attracts great attention by education authorities as well as by interested public. Cooperation among professional associations of history teachers in Western Balkan countries exists, but there is always a space and need for improvement. The existing regional network needs to be strengthened and to allow an additional number of teachers of history, civic education and democracy of all countries to get involved, which further strengthens cooperation, but also expands the dialogue on common past.

OBJECTIVES: The project supported by Western Balkans Fund aimed to raise awareness of national minorities and mixed cultures in the WB and importance of teaching the 'minorities history' in national curriculums, to develop joint teaching materials about the national minorities in WB and strengthening cooperation among history educators in 6 WB Contracting Parties through exchange and teacher training;

IMPACT: Summerschool was a place where 24 teachers from 6 Contracting Parties had an opportunity to build their capacities as educators and their associations for the teaching and learning about the shared past. The focus of the workshops was on responsible history teaching that goes beyond the traditional focus of pride and pain, with special emphasis on national minorities across the WB.



"Balkan – the Crossroads of Civilizations"
Responsible history education as a tool for
strengthening cooperation in the region.



Total: 17,080 EUR
WBF: 11,910 EUR



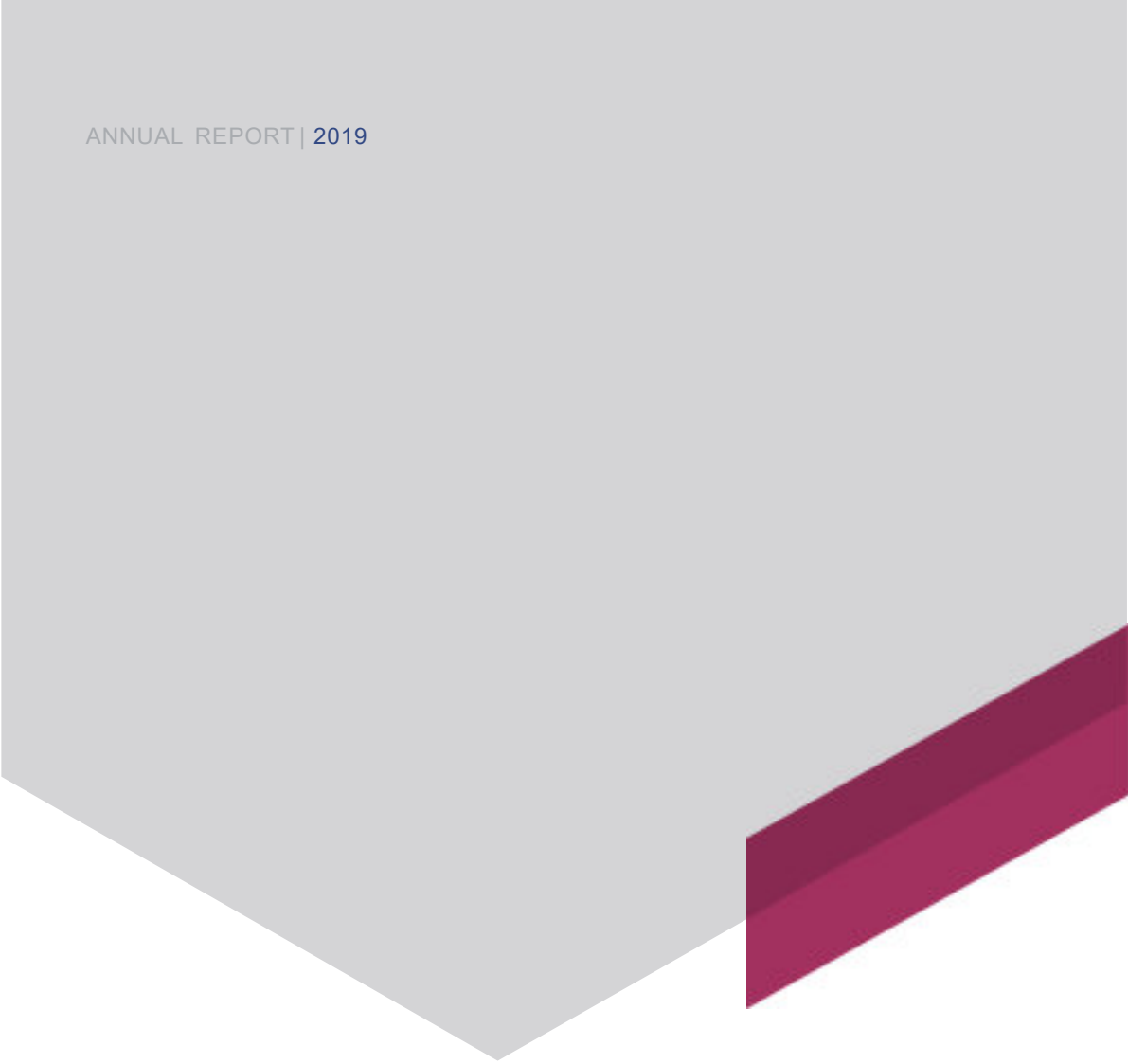
Banja Luka



June 2019 – October 2019



Teachers (subjects: history, civic, democracy) in elementary and high schools in 6 countries. At least 24 of them who will participate in concrete project activities; at least 300 other teachers will be involved in discussion and sharing joint practices via social media channels.



SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

57 applications

(28% OF TOTAL WBF 2'ND CALL PROJECTS)

Sustainable development prioritizes promotion and enabling socio-economic cooperation, including but not limited to employment, environment, local economic development that directly contribute to the regional cooperation and development. As a people to people driven fund, WBF is focused through this area of intervention to build collaborative economic relationships throughout the region, also seeking to improve and foster regional cooperation through small-scale projects that present “pre” conditions for short, medium and/or long-term impact by identifying and accelerating breakthrough solutions, ideas and dialogue.

YOUTH AWARENESS ON PRESSING CLIMATE CHANGE AND SUSTAINABILITY ISSUES

Academy of European Integration and Negotiation (AIEN)

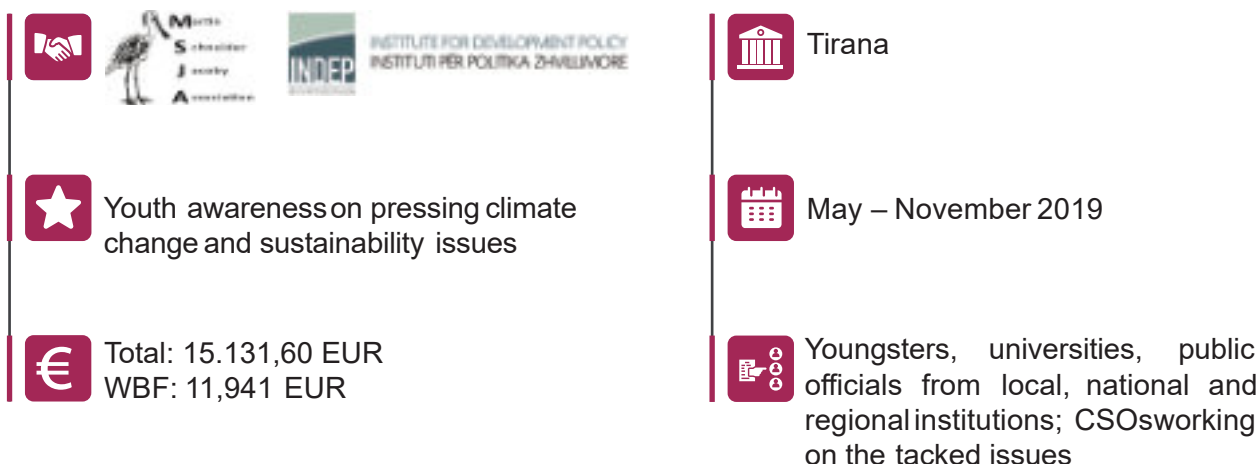


INTRODUCTION: The project “Youth awareness on pressing climate change and sustainability issues” aimed to contribute to a better-informed young generation on upcoming environmental challenges, strengthening the basis for planning for the inevitable consequences of climate change in the Western Balkan region.

OBJECTIVES: To increase knowledge of young people of the region about climate change risks and environmental issues in the Western Balkans that affect daily lifestyle; Stimulate debate and critical thinking of young people in the region about the climate change issues and upcoming environmental challenges; Exchange knowledge on the performance and challenges of the state institutions, regional structures, regarding EU standards in environment field; Exchange know how of young people perception of climate change impact in their home, their country and their region and their recommendations of influence as active and informed citizens.

RESULTS: Within the project framework the young people, learned about climate change risks and environmental issues in the Western Balkans that affect daily lifestyle. The project activities also simulated debate and critical thinking of youngsters through innovative methods in the region about the climate change issues and upcoming environmental challenges.





REGIONAL EXPORT PROMOTION

The Chamber of Doing Business in Kosovo*



INTRODUCTION: The Chamber of Doing Business in Kosovo* was established after a careful and detailed analysis of a group of businessmen who, saw great stagnation in the field of doing business, came together to give a more positive direction to the most important field in the country. In this context, founders of CDBK are successful business owners with many years of experience in Kosovo* and abroad, whose main goal is to increase the country's economy by offering alternatives to the field of business. The establishment of the CDBK is a new opportunity for businesses to have sincere cooperation with institutions and others in the field of relevant legislation, to react to many problems that businesses continue facing that is being transmitted in a form of great dissatisfaction. CDBK aims to become a viable partner with other Chambers around the region, therefore applied with other two Chambers of Commerce from Albania and North Macedonia with a project to better promote regional export aiming to foster the development of regionally business network stakeholders, competitive sectorial companies and will stimulate the innovation capacities of regional SMEs. By this initiative all three chambers promoted regional business initiatives and provided a link between SMEs.

OBJECTIVES: To support regional SMEs building market linkages, finding regional business, networking and business partners in the WB; To increase competitiveness of SMEs through close cooperation and regionalization aimed at creating partnerships between developers and implementers of with a particular focus on regional cooperation; To provide the multiple visibility, local awareness and recognition action through network and partners, social network and media, getting the workable partnership with Businesses and governments.

RESULTS: Creation of joint regional market linkages and networks in Kosovo*, North Macedonia, Montenegro and Albania for promotion and business cooperation opportunities; Development of promotion campaign for the regional business cooperation opportunities and export promotion

public and government; Expansion of business sphere into a regional level through organization of B2B event to be organized in Prishtine, with the participation from the region and producing a Booklet with Business profiles;

All three partners through this initiative helped to create an entrepreneurial conducive environment and promoted entrepreneurial culture in the region through an enhanced social dialogue with Governmental Institutions and Business networks. Three events took place that gathered over 100 businesses over the region and decision makers. Regional and national wide expertise possessed by all three partners and by combining the know-how ensured that participants increase their knowledge and identify most effective practices.



ICC
ALBANIA
INTERNATIONAL
CHAMBER
OF COMMERCE



OBLA EKONOMSKO E NJAZHODONIT VITRO-PRIVREDNI
STOLAN DLA PODROPA NA CENOP-VALANJA NAJ QJONHJA
ECONOMIC CHAMBER OF NORTH-WEST MACEDONIA



Prishtine



Regional Export Promotion



June 2019 - February 2020



Total: 14,500 EUR
WBFI: 10,900 EUR



SMEs, companies, export-oriented, self-employed, processors, start-ups, crafts, research institutions, intermediary organisations, local municipalities, public authorities, international businesses, bilateral chambers.

WOMAN'S BOOK

Balkan Women Association



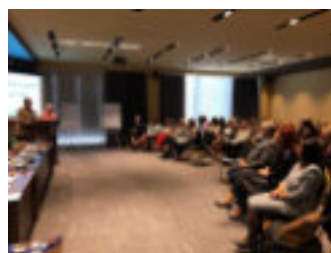
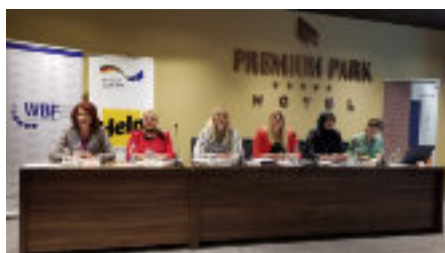
INTRODUCTION: Balkan Women Association (BWA)'s experience shows that the following methods foster capacity development, solidarity, and collaboration. Mentoring and training involves "learning by doing" approach that sustainably builds capacities.

Similarly, effective method for developing women's capacities, enabling them to put to practice skills and knowledge learned through mentoring and training when undertaking efforts to support women's economic development. The Action seeks to contribute to the overall objective in strengthening regional cooperation and regional cohesion in the WB6. Towards achieving this long-term objective, the Action's specific objectives are to strengthen CSO coalition from 6WB countries through knowledge and experience sharing; to improve the capacities of women entrepreneurs and potential future women entrepreneurs from 6WB countries; and to enable environment improve for strengthening regional cultural identity and intercultural dialogue in 6WB contracting parties by enhancing cooperation between institutions through cultural initiatives, activities and projects.

OBJECTIVES: Strengthening CSO coalition from 6WB countries through knowledge and experience sharing; Improving the capacities of women entrepreneurs and potential future women entrepreneurs from 6WB countries; Enabling environment improved for strengthening regional cultural identity and intercultural dialogue in 6WB counties, by enhancing cooperation between institutions through cultural initiatives, activities and projects.

RESULTS: Existing coalition of CSOs strengthened at regional level; Improved capacities, solidarity and representativeness of women entrepreneurs from 6WB counties, so they may effectively and reliably promote gender equality and women's economic development; Improved cooperative relations among CSOs and institutions; Improved cooperative relations among regional institutions.

All six partners came together for one goal enhancing cooperation among female entrepreneurs. WBF was one of the first donors to support this regional network that within the project organized lectures with students, workshops, conferences and produced a book that contains stories of successful female entrepreneurs around the region. The book is published and is available in all six languages with a title "Woman Book."



  	 Prishtine
 Woman's Book	 June 2019 - December 2019
 Total: 14,000 EUR WBF: 11,400 EUR	 Balkan Women Association (BWA) with its 6 implementing partner NGO's and their members, Women entrepreneurs from 6WB contracting parties, officials from Ministry of Culture and Ministry of Economic Development from 6WB countries, students from University in Pristina;

TOGETHER FOR IMPACT

Razlivalište



INTRODUCTION: Razlivalište from Serbia implemented the project "Together for impact", in consortia with Mozaik Foundation from Bosnia and Herzegovina, Innovation Center Kosovo* from Kosovo*, SFERA-NOVA from North Macedonia, and ACT Grupa from Croatia. Led by the internationally recognized Social Impact Award (SIA) program, together for impact - a first of its kind regional boot camp for young social innovators from the region was realized on 26-28 June 2019. This project served to connect young social innovators and provide them with a know-how in developing their social business ideas, and in parallel to increase their motivation for engaging in social entrepreneurship. Once boot camp finished, young social innovators went through a 3 months long support program - the incubation of their social business ideas developed and mentoring which altogether resulted to their pitching for a seed money and participation at the SIA international Summit.

OBJECTIVES: Connecting young social innovators from the WB region, and developing their skills and motivation upon social entrepreneurship.

RESULTS: Out of 137 applications submitted, the regional boot camp was realized for 60 participants – 44 young social innovators, and 16 mentors and facilitators who guided them through development process; 44 social business development plans created; out of 16 social business ideas selected for "pitching", 4 of them got awarded to receive seed funding and participate at international SIA Summit in order to further develop and scale.

Also, enabled environment of youth mobility, exchange of ideas, capacity building and social entrepreneurship within the WB6 region and beyond. Moreover, the project directly contributes to the expansion and further development of the social entrepreneurship ecosystem – outreaching from the national to the regional level.



Mozaik

ACTGRUPA



Together for impact



Total: 21,487.77 EUR
WBF: 10,500 EUR



Belgrade



June 2019-October 2019



Young people, Social enterprises, business associations, start-ups, local communities, youth workers, women, etc.

PROMOTION OF REGIONAL COOPERATION AND DIGITAL ECONOMY OPPORTUNITIES (PRODIGY)”

ICT Forum

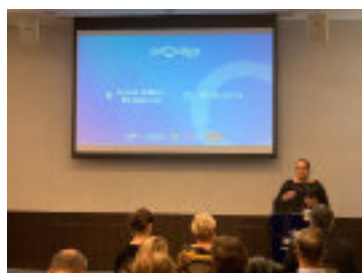


INTRODUCTION: ICT Forum is a non-profit organization that works on promoting innovation and technology. The PRODIGY conference brought together business support associations and entrepreneurs from Montenegro, Bosnia and Herzegovina, North Macedonia and Serbia, to discuss the terms of advanced cooperation in the area of digital services, and promote their findings as an impetus to future advancement and inclusion of partners from the remaining WB region. Thus, forging strong partnerships with relevant partners would contribute to the sustainable economic development in much more ways than verbal commitment.

OBJECTIVES: The project supported by WBF aimed to contribute to regional cohesion in the WB6 region, in the context of the promotion of digital services in economic cross-border cooperation between Montenegro, Serbia, North Macedonia and Bosnia and Herzegovina.

RESULTS: Within this conference lead applicant ICT Forum, has managed to increase cooperation between the business support associations in Montenegro, North Macedonia, Serbia and Bosnia and Herzegovina, as well as to promote best practices in the digitalization in entrepreneurial activities. This as well served as a great opportunity for all regional actors to jointly formulate policy guidelines for improved cross-border business cooperation in the specific area of digital services.

By supporting this project WBF has contributed to increase of understanding of the obstacles and opportunities for regional cooperation in the area of digital economy and increase of awareness on the practical solutions for promoting the digital transformation.





LET'S MAKE THE WESTERN BALKANS BETTER

Association of Young Ecologist Nikšić



INTRODUCTION: Association of Young Ecologist Nikšić is a non-profit organization whose mission is to improve and protect environment and natural resources in order to achieve goals of sustainable development through cooperation and involvement of wide spectrum of community stakeholders. Let's make the Western Balkans better is a project that gathered volunteers and eco enthusiasts from WB region in order to provide training and education to partners on how to better present cultural and

natural heritages in their communities, as well as to strengthen regional cooperation by forming Greeter Service.

OBJECTIVES: One of the main aims of this project was contribute to promotion of marginal and rural areas in partner communities by creating innovative content and promotional material for greeter tours in the region.

RESULTS: Lead applicant and partners have managed to train 15 volunteers to be greeters and to position themselves in global network of greeters. 16 locations have been mapped and presented in regional Greeter Guide. By becoming members of Global Greeter Network, the lead applicant and partners have already conducted 5 tours with international guests.

Capacities of partner organizations on promotion of rural places and interest of local communities to become trained greeters has greatly increased.



Wake up" Citizens' Association;
Mountain Club "Kamena Gora"



Let's make the Western Balkans
better



Total: 14,757 EUR
WBF: 10,941 EUR



Nikšić



May 2019 – April 2020



Volunteers from Montenegro, Bosnia
and Herzegovina and Serbia; rural
communities; NGOs working in the
field of ecology and eco-tourism.

WINE AS A BRIDGE OF COOPERATION IN THE WESTERN BALKANS

Association Wines of Macedonia



INTRODUCTION: Association Wines of Macedonia is an organization that provides strategic support to the Macedonian wine sector including developing the wine and viticulture industry in Republic of North Macedonia. Through project Wine as a bridge of cooperation in the Western Balkans, lead applicant and the partners have joined forces and created a regional network for wine organizations and producers in order to build their capacities to jointly advocate

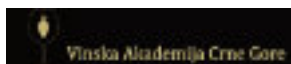
for regional policies.

OBJECTIVES: The aim of this project was to achieve strengthened and strategically structured voice of a regional network of complementary organizations and actors in the wine sector, to influence regional, national and local policies and strategies for promoting sustainable development and improvements of the wine industries in the Western Balkan.

RESULTS: Regional network of wine organizations called Balkan Wine Network has been created and capacity building workshops for 12 regional associations and clusters through know-how exchange was organized during which the first strategic Action Plan 2020-2022 of the Balkan Wine Network has been created and adopted.



wineO



Skopje



Wine as a bridge of cooperation in the Western Balkans



June 2019 – March 2020



Total: 13,255 EUR
WBF: 10,700 EUR



Grape growers from WB region, wineries and the wine sector; local business from eco and gastronomical sector; start-ups; local authorities

BEYOND GRANTS

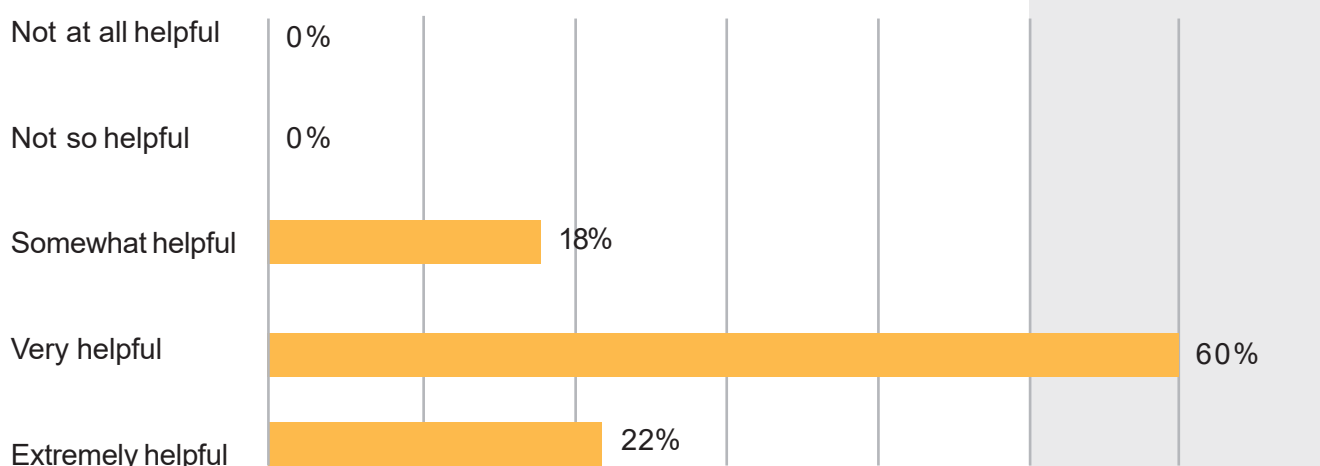
Capacity Development

In the Western Balkan region, there is a continuous emerging need for support to CSO-s development, as the engine of human and society development. WBF's capacity development support contains elements that are focused on coaching and training as a process through which individuals, organizations and societies obtain, strengthen and maintain the capabilities to set and achieve their own development objectives over time.

An essential ingredient in the WBF capacity development approach is the transformation. For an activity to meet the standard of capacity development as practiced and promoted by WBF, it must bring about transformation that is generated and sustained over time from within. Transformation of this kind goes beyond performing tasks; instead, it is more a matter of changing mind-sets and attitudes especially in terms of regional cooperation and people to people links. WBF extends its support on capacity development for grant recipients in thinking proactively about sustainability, which includes planning, expanding initiatives and gaining community level support that will enable their initiatives to continue beyond the life of these short projects.

For WBF, capacity development actions are based on the principle of listening and learning from our partners. Within the framework of Call for Proposals, we presented a survey where applicants gave their impression on WBF Call and support provided by the WBF team; 82% of applicants only in the last Call for Proposal stated that WBF's Secretariat advisory support was tremendously important for them during the project proposal development, also during the Information Session 73% of participants stated that the hands on experience is much more valuable than reading guidelines.

8. How helpful was WBF Secretariat responding to your inquiries?





MENTORING AND MONITORING

Despite limited capacity to date, WBF remains committed to conducting monitoring and evaluation of its grants, for several reasons:

- a. to best support its grantees and help them understand the impact they are making to improve their effectiveness,
- b. to better understand how WBF's operations contribute to social change,
- c. to adapt its approach to meet the needs of its stakeholders and
- d. to build internal capacity to enable WBF to consistently strive for excellence in how it conducts its operations.

WBF learned from its grantees within the 1st and 2nd Call that mentoring and coaching was very important as it is a process for the informal transmission of knowledge, social capital, and the professional support relevant to the mission of WBF. Out of 43 grantees 9 of them continued working regionally in the same partnership with other funds, meaning that the experience with WBF resulted successful and sustainable.

WBF's experience thus far has enabled it to identify specific areas where mentoring is particularly in demand, and these are: PCM – project cycle management technical support, including thematic expertise in areas such as reconciliation, intercultural learning and dialogue, and more broadly international (cross-border) engagements and relations. Additional confirmation for the need of this support derived from applicants in our survey where they stated that, WBF team is good facilitator in bringing CSOs from the region closer with the aim to better promote and strengthen regional cooperation in the Western Balkans. WBF is committed to continuing these investments going forward. Through its operating to date, WBF has learned that mentoring support is in demand, and particularly so for organizations that:

- are new/young;
- are small and with very limited capacity;
- are new to cross-border and regional cooperation actions or;
- have distinct internal needs, regardless of size or track-record, to become more effective agents of regional cooperation;

Due to its importance, the Fund intends to invest in strengthening of its internal capacities to be able to provide more intense, tailored, accessible and consistent mentoring support to those grantees that express the need for it. Our Secretariat is fully engaged with visits, meetings and communication with the projects, to make sure that they are successfully implemented.



Joint Workshop organized by the Chamber of Doing Business, Prishtina



Joint Conference on the “European Integration of the Western Balkans: Making a Realistic Perspective Out of a Shifting Target”, Tirana



Joint Meeting in “Exchanging experiences in Promoting Cultural and Natural Diversity” between representatives of the Municipalities of Cetinje, Ferizaj and Çair. Cetinje



Regional Conference “Media and Democratization in the Western Balkans – Are We Reaching Our Goals?”, Prishtina



Conference “Promotion of Regional Cooperation and Digital Economy Opportunities (Prodigy)”, organized by ICT Forum, Podgorica.



“Common Understanding on National Minorities and Mix of Cultural and Traditions within the Regions”, organized By EuroClio, Podgorica.

VISIBILITY ACTIONS

Promotion of WBF's actions focuses on obtaining a wider public outreach and is conducted based on following elements: Aware - People know we exist, meaning WBF; (newsletter, annual reports, press conferences, website hyperlink, interviews on media, visit to the website, shares on Facebook, and comments) Interested - People give us permission to communicate with them (WBF Facebook Partnership Platform, visits in WBF office, direct emails, and Facebook followers) Engaged - People take action to support regional cause (apply for WBF Calls, direct emails, share our news, give comments, and participate in WBF's events such as Information Sessions, Conferences etc.

Social media channels are the first stop where our team can engage with our audience, measured by: conversation rate that include number of replies/comments over post that WBF makes, number of shares, number of likes and number of views. This gives us enough information how well WBF's activities are promoted and how much impact we are having in the public awareness. Moreover, WBF promotes actions conducted by grantees in all WBF's communication and social media channels.

Social Media - WBF encounters around 10,000 followers in Facebook page, 1,800 followers in Twitter and 1,150 followers in Instagram. WBF is active and regular in providing information to its followers on daily basis and publishes declarations, press releases, publications, documents, and instructions in real time.



Western Balkans Fund



@balkans_fund



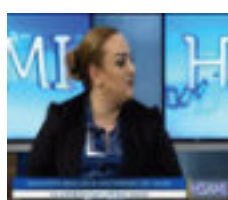
Western Balkans Fund WBF

@westernbalkansfund

Newsletter- Western Balkans Fund Secretariat prepares and produces its Newsletter on monthly basis and it is shared with all stakeholders within the region and beyond. This promotional tool helped WBF to establish relationships and maintain regular contact with stakeholders, donor community, governments and beneficiaries and it is distributed each month to over 5.000 e-mails addresses.

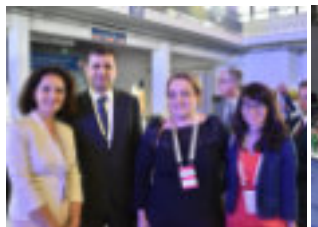
Broadcasting- The year 2019 was very rich in terms of media coverage for Western Balkans Fund. WBF representatives were present in local media in all contracting parties; giving interviews for television news programs, morning shows etc.

Traditional media remains one of the promotional tools that keeps WBF closer to all citizens of the Western Balkans region and further promotes regional cooperation as a tool toward reconciliation processes.



NETWORKING WITHIN AND BEYOND THE WB REGION

WBF understands networking as a tool to establish and nurture long-term, mutually beneficial relationships with its stakeholders. During the year 2019, Western Balkans Fund has positioned as one of the most important actors in the regional cooperation processes in Western Balkans. Through its active participation, WBF managed to be part of over 160 activities, conferences, annual meetings, summits and bilateral meetings with different stakeholders within the region and beyond.

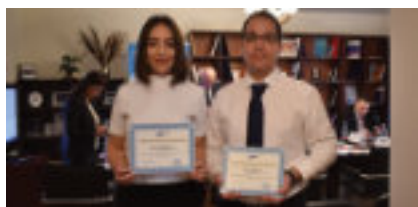


WESTERN BALKANS FUND INTERNSHIP PROGRAM

In November-December 2019, with Swiss Government support, WBF introduced a new initiative: The Internship opportunity, aiming to enable youngsters from the Western Balkans region to gain first-hand exposure of working, to allow them to harness the skill, knowledge, and theoretical practice they learned during their studies.

WBF first internship program provided with a nice learning curve for two talented youngsters: Mrs. Fiona Haxhiislami from Pristina and Mr. Boris Lipovina from Podgorica.

This first pilot programme will be followed by similar opportunities in the upcoming period



WBF 3rd CALL FOR PROPOSALS FOR REGIONAL PROJECTS



DURATION AND LOCATION



Duration of WBF Grants

The planned duration of WBF Grants shall not exceed 12 months.



Location of WBF Grants

Implementation of rewarded projects shall take place in the WB6



Partnership

Implementation of rewarded projects consists at least of 3 partner from 3 different WBF CPs

SIZE OF THE GRANT

The total amount requested from the Fund through 3rd Call for Proposals is 3.3 million €, while the total value proposed projects is 4.7 million €.

Available through the second Call for Proposals of the WBF

EUR 250.000

SCHEME SIZE

Maximum amount that grant requested under this Call for Proposals must not exceed

EUR 12.000

GRANT SIZE

Maximum amount of WBF funding per individual grant

80 %

COST-SHARING



WBF 2019 ANNUAL REPORT

CONTACT US



Rruga "Skënderbeg"
No. 8, Kati IV, Ap. 35/36.
Tirana, Albania



+355 42 400420



info@westernbalkansfund.org